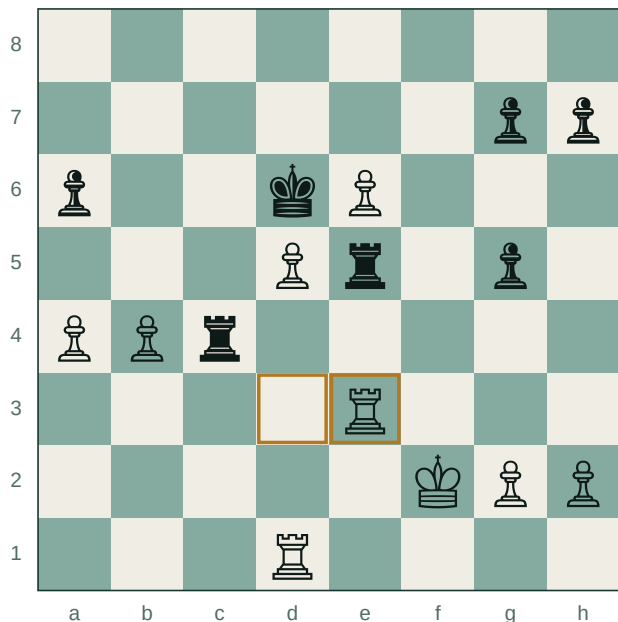


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 40

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Re3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40...Rc2+ 41. Kf3 g4+ 42. Kg3 Rxe3+

40...Rc2+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **41.Kf3**.

41...g4+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **42.Kg3**.

42...Rxe3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on f2. Geometrically undefended: rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.